▼ GLASSHOUSE



SELFIE SARKAR

For years, Yogi Adityanath's political persona was all saffron and stern, with zero tolerance to a lot many things. But after almost a decade in the chief minister's seat, and with the 2027 Uttar Pradesh election coming up, Yogi seems to be trying for a more 'friendly' image makeover. In late August alone, he was seen posing with Japanese students, newly employed youth with their appointment letters, and with the ladies at a special bus service launched for them. A most striking selfie was with a student from Japan's Yamanashi prefecture, who was seen casually putting an arm around him and flashing a victory sign, leaving Yogi laughing. Three constituencies, three photo-ops, one unmistakable message. Team Yogi wants voters to see a more accessible version of him. The bulldozer image, it seems, now comes with a front-facing camera.

Illustrations by **SIDDHANT JUMDE**

▼ NANDIGRAM TO NABANNA

PANDAL POLITICS

Kolkata's Durga Puja pandals have over the years reflected the social milieu of their times. In that spirit, the Akhil Bharatiya Hindu Mahasabha's Ruby area pandal will celebrate CM **Suvendu Adhikari's** journey from Nandigram, his home turf and the epicentre of Bengal's anti-land acquisition movement that brought down the Left in the state, to Nabanna, the state secretariat. The pandal will feature a bust, a documentary and even



the West Bengal CM's face recreated using moong dal. Adhikari and governor R.N. Ravi are expected to visit. The Ruby area pandal has some history too. In 2022, the same organisers had caused major outrage by depicting Mahatma Gandhi as the shape-shifting demon, Mahishasura. Four years later, they are now celebrating Suvendu's conquest of Nabanna as the first BJP and "sanatani" chief minister. Puja themes, like politics, clearly change with the season.